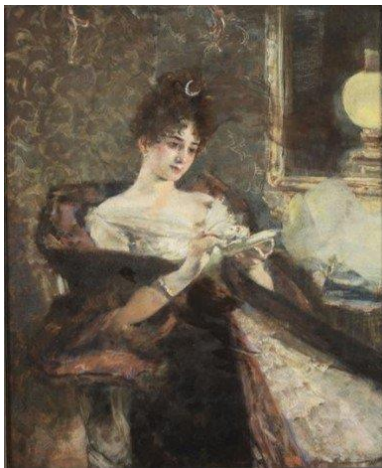


A resident of Marlotte, the painter François Thévenot died 80 years ago

Arthur François Thévenot was born on December 29, 1856, in the 18th arrondissement of Paris. At the National School of Fine Arts, he took lessons from the painter Émile Bin and the sculptor Justin Lequien, before exhibiting his work at the Salon des Artistes Français in 1878. He received a 3rd class medal there in 1885 (two paintings exhibited, *Le Déjeuner* and *Un Philosophe*), then a 2nd class medal in 1891 (two paintings exhibited *Portrait* and *Jardin*), after which it was ranked “out of competition”. During this period, he was also a member of the Society of French Pastelists, where he exhibited his works annually. *Madame Gelhay or The Cup of Tea* is a fine example of such a pastel, produced in 1887 and now on display at the Château-Museum of Nemours (see below).



Autoportrait, by François Thévenot, 1891



Madame Gelhay ou *La tasse de thé*, 1887



Illustration of *Une Page d'Amour* by Zola, 1895

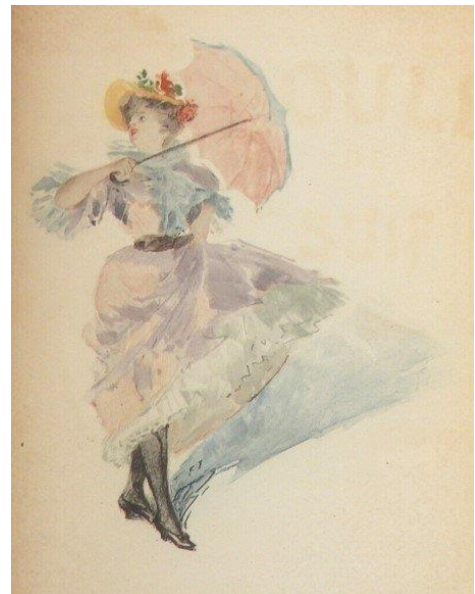
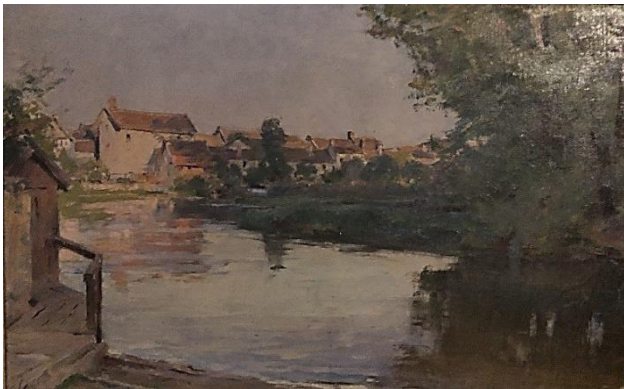


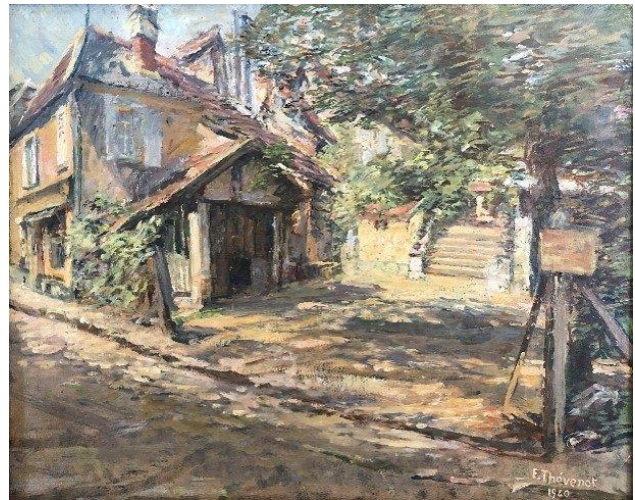
Illustration of *Boule de Suif* by Maupassant, 1897

His contributions are not limited to paintings and include decorations, such as that commissioned by the French State for the ceiling of the Limoges prefecture. François Thévenot is still noted for numerous book illustrations, including *Boule de Suif* by Maupassant, *La Légende de l'Aigle* by d'Esparbès, and *Page d'Amour* by Zola (see above). In this last work, the press of the time noted that the painter, in around a hundred compositions, showed the rarest qualities of an outstanding illustrator.

Having frequented the Nemours region since his youth and painted numerous landscapes of this region, towards the end of his life, Thévenot often retired to the villa *Les Catalpas*, at 26 rue Delort in Marlotte, where he had a studio. The painting *Boulangerie à Marlotte* is a witness to the painter's retirement in our village... and the bakery is still present today!



Le Loing à Nemours



La boulangerie à Marlotte

On March 18, 1943, François Thévenot died in his house of Marlotte. He is buried in the old cemetery of Saint-Pierre-lès-Nemours.

A more complete article on this painter is being prepared for publication in a future Bulletin des Amis de Bourron-Marlotte.